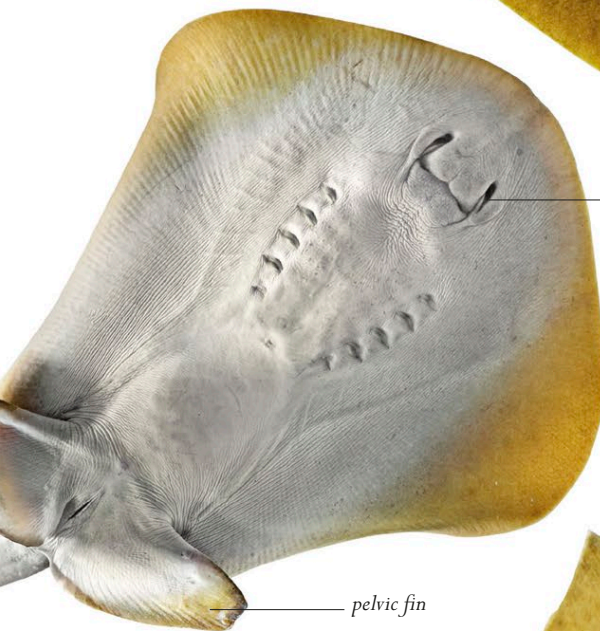




pectoral fin

^ HIDDEN SPOTS

Unlike most of its relatives, the blue-spotted ribbontail ray rarely buries itself in sand, relying instead on its camouflage colours. Although bright, its blue spots break up the ray's outline when seen from above in the shifting sunlight of a shallow coral reef.



mouth

pelvic fin

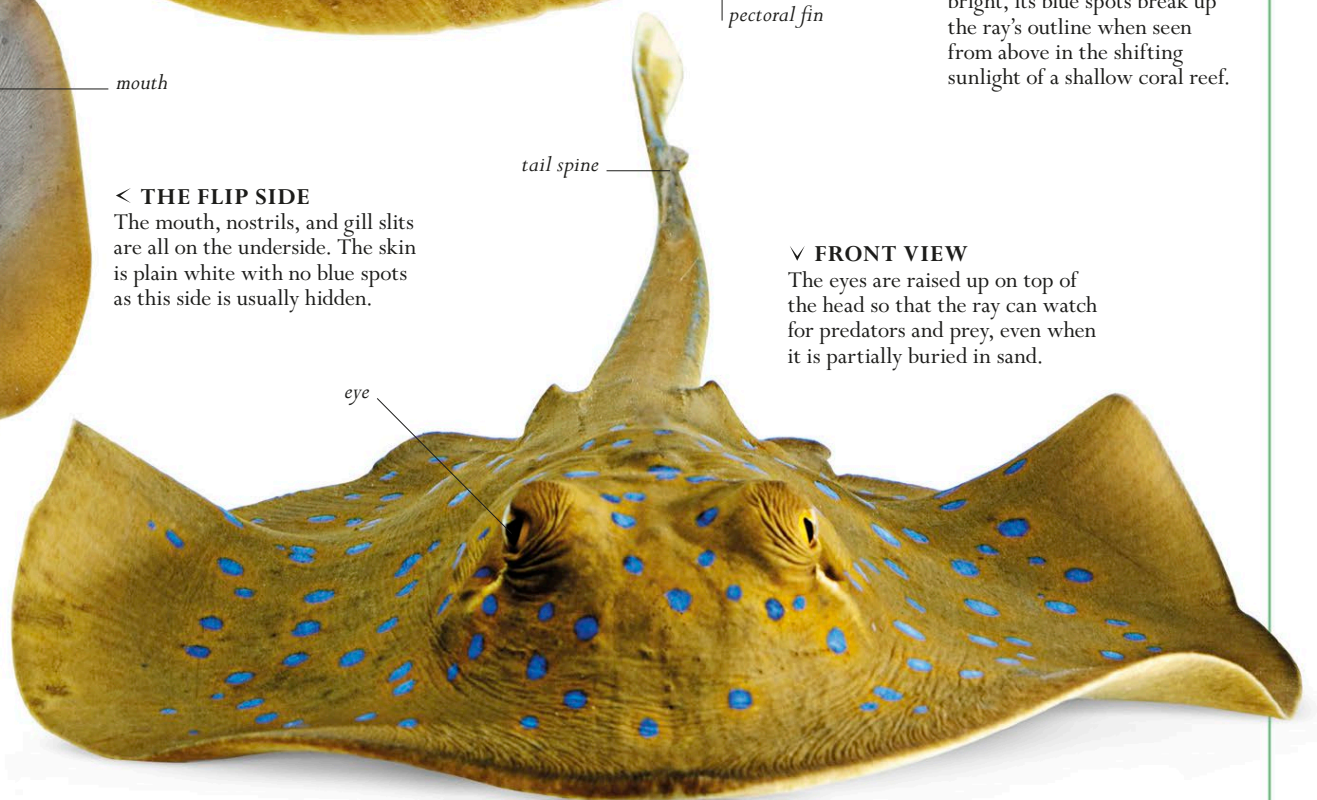
< THE FLIP SIDE

The mouth, nostrils, and gill slits are all on the underside. The skin is plain white with no blue spots as this side is usually hidden.

tail spine

✓ FRONT VIEW

The eyes are raised up on top of the head so that the ray can watch for predators and prey, even when it is partially buried in sand.



eye